



MOST DEADLY

Many people die from snake bites. These five snakes are among the most venomous.

○ FER-DE-LANCE

The most feared snake in South America, it tends to live dangerously close to humans.

○ PUFF ADDER

Thick-bodied and slow, this African viper blows up its body and hisses if it feels threatened.

○ AUSTRALIAN TAIPAN

Anyone bitten by this taipan needs immediate medical treatment.

○ KING COBRA

This long snake is found in India and Southeast Asia. Just one of its bites could kill an elephant.

○ BLACK MAMBA

The fast-moving mamba is responsible for many human deaths in its native Africa.

THE BIG SQUEEZE

A constrictor, like a python or boa, catches its prey by striking fast and seizing the animal with its sharp teeth. Then the snake wraps its body around the victim and suffocates it by gradually tightening its coils.



1 GETTING A GRIP
The snake squeezes its victim to death.



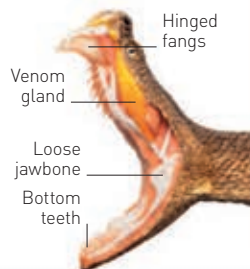
2 HEAD FIRST
Its prey held head first, the snake is ready to eat.



3 SWALLOWING DOWN
Mouth open wide, the snake gulps down its meal.

A POISONOUS BITE

Venomous snakes have hollow fangs through which poison is squirted from glands in their mouth. In some species, the fangs move forwards on a hinge when the snake bites its victim.



COLOSSAL CONSTRICTOR

A 60-million-year-old fossil of a monster snake was found in Colombia. Named Titanoboa, it was 15 m (50 ft) long and weighed 1,130 kg (2,500 lb).

Titanoboa:
Length 15 m (50 ft)



Average human:
Height 1.8 m (6 ft)



**AFTER A LARGE MEAL A BOA
MAY NOT EAT AGAIN FOR
WEEKS OR EVEN MONTHS**